

Chapter 2

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet for Chapter 2: Communicating the Canadian Way

Part 1: Self-Reflection (Understanding Your Communication Style)

Purpose: Reflect on how your current communication style aligns with or differs from Canadian norms to identify areas for growth. **Instructions:** Answer the following questions in 3-5 sentences each. Be honest and specific. If possible, discuss your answers with a friend or mentor for feedback.

- **Indirect Communication:** How does your home culture handle indirectness or directness in communication? Are hints and subtle cues common, or do people speak plainly? How do you think this will affect your interactions in Canada, where indirectness is often used?
- **Politeness Norms:** In your culture, how often are words like “please,” “thank you,” or “sorry” used? Do you find Canada’s frequent use of these terms (including apologizing when not at fault) natural or unusual? How will you adapt to this norm?

Part 2: Practical Task (Email Drafting Practice)

Purpose: Develop skills in writing professional emails following Canadian etiquette for academic or workplace settings. **Instructions:** Draft a short email based on the scenario below. Use the structure and tone guidelines from Chapter 2 (formal greeting, clear subject line, concise purpose, polite closing). Once completed, review your draft against the checklist provided.

Scenario: You are requesting a one-day extension for an assignment from your professor, Dr. Emily Brown, due to a scheduling conflict. Your student ID is 456789, and the assignment is for Sociology 200, due on October 10th.

Your Email Draft: Subject: _____ **Dear**

Sincerely,

Checklist for Review:

- Does the subject line clearly state the purpose (e.g., “Extension Request for Sociology 200 Assignment”)?
- Is the greeting formal (e.g., “Dear Dr. Brown,”)?
- Is the purpose stated clearly and concisely in the first 1-2 sentences?
- Are polite phrases like “thank you” or “I appreciate” included?
- Is the closing polite (e.g., “Sincerely” or “Best regards”) with your name?
- Are there no slang, emojis, or spelling errors?

Reflection: After reviewing, what is one strength of your email, and one area to improve?

Part 3: Scenario Analysis (Navigating Real-Life Situations)

Purpose: Apply Canadian communication norms to realistic scenarios you might encounter. **Instructions:** Read each scenario below and write a short response (2-3 sentences) on how you would handle the situation using concepts from Chapter 2 (e.g., indirectness, politeness, active listening, feedback).

- **Scenario 1 - Indirect Hint:** You're at a friend's house, and they say, "It's getting pretty late, isn't it?" while glancing at the clock. What do you think they mean, and how would you respond?
- **Scenario 2 - Receiving Feedback:** Your professor comments, "Your presentation had great content, but the pacing was a bit fast. Try slowing down next time." How would you respond to show openness to feedback?
- **Scenario 3 - Small Talk:** You're waiting at a bus stop, and a stranger comments, "This rain just won't let up, eh?" How would you continue the small talk in a Canadian way?

Part 4: Role-Play Preparation (Practicing Communication Skills)

Purpose: Build confidence in applying Canadian communication norms through simulated interactions.

Instructions: Choose one of the role-play activities below to practice (solo by imagining responses or with a friend/group). Prepare by writing 3-5 key phrases or strategies you'll use based on Chapter 2 concepts. Then, perform the role-play and note one takeaway afterward.

Option 1: Small Talk at a Café

- Situation: You're at a coffee shop and want to start a casual chat with the person next to you in line.
- Key Phrases/Strategies (e.g., safe topics like weather, open-ended questions):
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- Takeaway After Practice (What did you learn or find challenging?):

Option 2: Giving Constructive Feedback

- Situation: You're reviewing a classmate's project draft and need to suggest improvements politely.
- Key Phrases/Strategies (e.g., sandwich method, focus on action not person):
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- Takeaway After Practice (What did you learn or find challenging?):

Part 5: Action Plan for Continued Practice

Purpose: Create a personalized plan to keep developing your communication skills before arriving in Canada.

Instructions: Based on your reflections and activities above, set two specific goals related to Canadian communication norms. Include how and when you'll practice them over the next week or month.

- **Goal 1** (e.g., "Improve small talk by starting conversations with strangers"):
 - What: _____
 - How: _____
 - When: _____
- **Goal 2** (e.g., "Practice saying 'sorry' and 'thank you' in every interaction"):

- What: _____
- How: _____
- When: _____

Commitment: I will track my progress on these goals by (e.g., journaling, discussing with a friend):